



1.8 | GETTING A PERSONAL DRIVER LICENSE

INSTRUCTION PERMIT

Before applying for an instruction permit, you need to have a WDL number.

If you are enrolling in a driver training course

You can apply for your permit as early as 15 years old. Apply at a driver licensing office or online 1 to 10 days before your course starts. Be prepared to give your WDL number to your driving school for record keeping.

If you are not enrolling in a driver training course

You can take the knowledge exam after you turn 15½. Once you pass, you'll get your permit. However, you need to wait until you're 18 to take the skills exam and get your license.

Your permit is valid for 1 year (can be renewed for a fee). Your knowledge exam score is valid for 2 years. If you wait too long to take your skills exam, you may have to take the knowledge exam again.

There are a variety of IDs, licenses, and endorsements for Washington residents.